

Instructions for sterilizing at Biomedicum 1 and 2U

If you have any wishes regarding the products, for example, you need certain products to be sterilized, please send a request to our joint email:

valinehuolto-meilahti@helsinki.fi

When you send us a message, please remember to tell us which lab you are working in, which floor your lab is located on (including which house), and your contact information so that we can contact you if needed.

Products to be sterilized

The products will be ready at the earliest the next day.

- The **expiry date** of the product is indicated on the products. In the case of two dates, the earlier date is the date of sterilization.
 - Incubator shelves are sterilized only for old incubators that do not have a decontamination program. (Of course, we wash the shelves of all incubators).
 - Certain items are automatically sterilized after washing, for example, ultracentrifuge tubes and instruments. These products are marked by equipment maintenance using autoclavable marking tapes.

Do the following:

- If you need general glassware to be sterilized (eg, Erlenmeyers, etc.), send us a service request by email. We will bring you the product you requested, as soon as we can, to the service point nearest you.
- If you wish to have your clean items (eg, Eppendorf tubes, etc.) back sterilized, bring them in sterilizing bags to the nearest service point.
 - Fill the bag only up to 60%. Otherwise, steam may not disperse around all products and sterilize them properly. Also, the bag must have space for the seams.
 - The text should be **at the end of the bag**, i.e., outside the seams, not in the sterile region
 - Be sure to send the tip boxes to be washed from time to time.

Avoid the following:

- Putting dirty items needing to be washed among clean things to be sterilized, because we have to assume that all items are contaminated and rewash them all.
- Putting a clean product to be sterilized (eg, sterilization bag) in a dirty washbasin. The product is contaminated, and we have to dispose of the bag and its goods in the trash.
- To bag a dirty product in an autoclave bag. Please follow the instructions above. We assume that the bagged items are clean and ready for sterilization.

Liquids to be sterilized

Bring all liquids to be sterilized to the service point, where the service personnel will retrieve them.

- Always **mark on the bottle what the solution is**. The personnel will not autoclave unknown liquids. (Quality and safety issue). Also, mark **who's it is** (Lab name and location, for example, lab A, 2U, 3floor) so that we know where to return it.
 - Fill bottles with only 70% of the bottle volume. Otherwise, the liquids will boil over in the autoclave.
 - Critical concentration solutions, such as 10XPBS can be filled up to 85% volume, because they are run with a slower, more water-consuming program. Before the delivery of the bottles for sterilization, **contact us to discuss the matter** via our email.
 - DEPC waters and DEPC-flushed, bagged products are also brought to a service point. They are not picked up by laboratory technicians from fume hoods. (DEPC evaporates CO₂ and ethanol in small amounts so that they can be safely taken to a service point).

Marking the products:

- If you use your own printed stickers on the caps, please use dry-heat indicator tape beneath it. Otherwise, the stickers are very hard to remove.
- When you mark your bottles do not “go wild” with tape. Please see the examples below.

